COP15–29 拼圖閱讀卡

Expert Group A

COP15 — Copenhagen

2009 · Denmark

COP15 in Copenhagen was expected to produce a strong new global climate treaty. Instead, it became remembered as one of the most disappointing COPs in history. After two tense weeks, world leaders could only agree on a short, non-binding statement called the Copenhagen Accord — it set a goal of limiting warming to 2°C, but included no binding targets and no way to enforce them.

Developing countries accused wealthy nations of negotiating privately behind closed doors, bypassing the normal United Nations process. The disappointment of Copenhagen became an important lesson: six years later, COP21 was deliberately designed to avoid Copenhagen's mistakes.

Key terms: Copenhagen Accord, non-binding, closed-door negotiation

Expert Group B

COP21 — Paris

2015 · France

COP21, held in Paris, is remembered as one of the most successful COPs in history. Learning from Copenhagen's failure six years earlier, negotiators designed a new structure: instead of forcing every country to accept the same binding target, each country submitted its own individual plan, called an NDC (Nationally Determined Contribution).

This flexible approach allowed nearly 200 countries — from small island nations to major industrial powers — to agree to one shared long-term goal: keeping global warming "well below 2°C," and pursuing efforts to limit it to 1.5°C. The Paris Agreement remains the foundation every COP since has built on.

Key terms: NDC, Nationally Determined Contribution, 1.5°C / 2°C goal

Expert Group C

COP26 — Glasgow

2021 · United Kingdom

At COP26 in Glasgow, nearly 200 countries signed the Glasgow Climate Pact. For the first time in the history of COP, the final agreement directly mentioned coal, calling for countries to work toward "phasing down" its use. Some delegates wanted stronger wording — "phasing out" completely — but India and a few other coal-dependent countries pushed for the softer term at the last minute.

Countries also agreed to a Global Methane Pledge, promising to cut methane emissions by 30% by 2030, since methane traps far more heat than carbon dioxide in the short term.

Expert Group D

COP27 — Sharm El-Sheikh

2022 · Egypt

COP27, hosted in Egypt, is remembered mainly for one historic decision: the creation of the Loss and Damage Fund. For decades, vulnerable countries — especially small island nations and low-lying coastal states — had argued that they suffer the worst effects of climate change despite contributing the least to global emissions.

At COP27, wealthy nations finally agreed to set up a fund to help pay for the damage already happening: flooding, droughts, and lost farmland. Many details, including exactly how much money and who would pay, were left to be worked out at later COPs.

Key terms: phase down / phase out, methane pledge, coal-dependent

Key terms: Loss and Damage Fund, vulnerable countries, low-lying coastal states

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Expert Group E

COP28 — Dubai

2023 · United Arab Emirates

COP28 completed the first "Global Stocktake," a formal review of how far the world had come since the Paris Agreement — and the answer was: not far enough. The final agreement included, for the first time ever, language calling on countries to begin "transitioning away from fossil fuels."

The location sparked controversy: the UAE, the host country, is itself a major oil producer, and the COP28 president also led the country's national oil company. Supporters said having oil-producing nations at the table was necessary for real change; critics called it a conflict of interest.

Key terms: Global Stocktake, transitioning away from fossil fuels, conflict of interest

Expert Group F

COP29 — Baku

2024 · Azerbaijan

COP29 was nicknamed the "finance COP" because its central question was simple but difficult: how much money should wealthy countries provide to help developing countries fight climate change and adapt to its effects? After tense, extended negotiations, developed nations agreed to a new goal of at least $300 billion per year by 2035.

Many developing countries and climate advocates said the number was far too low compared to what is actually needed, while some wealthy nations argued it already stretched their budgets. The gap between the two sides showed just how hard climate finance negotiations remain.

Key terms: climate finance, developed / developing nations, $300 billion goal